



Episode 2 – Greetings in Tunisian Arabic: How to Say Hello and More!

In this episode, we explore the most common ways to greet people in Tunisian Arabic. You'll learn how to say "hello," "how are you?" and how to reply politely and naturally. We also explain when to use different greetings depending on the time of day and the formality of the situation.

Transcription

[Music]

3asslema ana Mongia inshallah

عَسَلَامَة أَنَا مِنْجِيَة إِن شَاءَ اللَّهُ

Intouma labes il-youm bach na9raou kifach tsallem 3ala la3bed ou bach n9ollekom

إنتوما لاباس، اليوم باش نقرأو كيفاش تسلم على العباد، وباش نقولكم

jdod expressions

جُدُد.

Yomken inti awel mara tasma3hom

يمكن أنتي أول مرة تسمعهم

Hello, I'm Mongia. I hope everyone is doing well. Today we will learn how to greet people, and I will share expressions that you might hear for the first time. Let's begin.

[Music]

Let's start with the basic Tunisian Arabic greetings.

To greet someone in a normal everyday way, you can say:

3asleema

عَسَلَامَة

slema

سلام

Both mean hello.

When greeting someone you know, you can say:



ahla

أهلا

ahla bik

أهلا بك

Which means hi or hello to you.

The most formal and standard way to greet someone is:

Assalamu 3alaikum

السلام عليكم

And to reply, you say:

Wa3alikum assalam

وعليكم السلام

To say good morning:

Sba7 el-khir

صباح الخير

And to reply, you say:

Sba7 innour

صباح النور

To say goodbye, you can say:

bisslema

بسلامة

And to say goodnight, you can say:

Tisba7 3ala khir

تصبح على خير

Now let's go over these first greetings again. Try to repeat after me.

- 3asleema (hello) — عسلامة
- Salam (hello) — سلام
- Ahla (hi) — أهلا
- Ahla bik (hi / hello to you) — أهلا بك
- Sbe7 il-khir (good morning) — صباح الخير
- Sba7 innour (good morning, reply) — صباح النور



- Bisslema (goodbye) — بالسلامة
 - Tisba7 3ala khir (goodnight) — تصبّح على خير
-

Now, let's talk about how you can say “**how are you?**”

In Tunisian Arabic, there are different ways to ask someone how they are doing. The most common are:

Chna7walek?

شحوالك؟

(how are you)

Labes?

لاباس؟

(Are you OK?)

“Ça va” is a French expression. It means: **Are you OK?** And also: **Ça va means I'm fine.**

You can also say*:**

Jawek bahi?

جوك باهي؟

(Your mood is good? / Is everything going well?)

What it literally means is “is your mood good?” or in the meaning of “is everything going well?”

Jawek bahi is an expression that I recommend you to use it with your friends.

Now, how can you reply to “**Chna7walek**”, “**Labes**”, and “**Jawek bahi**”?

To reply to these greetings, you can say:

Labes

لاباس

(I'm fine)

7amdulah

الحمد لله

(Thanks God)

Labes 7amdulah

لاباس، الحمد لله

(I'm fine, thanks God) or



Jawi bahi

جوي باهي

(I'm feeling good / I'm in a good mood)

Or simply, you can use the French expression and say “ça va.”

But what if you are not feeling well? How can you reply?

In that case, you can say:

Manich labes

ما نيش لاباس

(I'm not OK)

Or:

Manich ça va

ما نيش صافا (I'm not OK — using the French expression)

Which means *I'm not feeling well*.

Notice here that مانيش – **manich** literally means *I'm not* in English.

For example:

مانيش لاباس – **manich labes** = I'm not okay.

مانيش ça va – **manich ça va**

or for example

مانيش فرّسويّة – **manich fransawiyya**

You can use **manich** in different ways. It's a very useful word to express **negation** in Tunisian Arabic.

What if you're feeling neither good nor bad?

You can say:

هكاكا أو برا – **hakkaka ou barra** = Just like that / So-so / It's okay



I hope this lesson is useful, and I hope you'll enjoy it

Stay tuned for the next episode. Where you'll learn more and more useful expressions in Tunisian Arabic!

Thank you for listening, and see you in the next episode.

بالسلامة – *bisslema!* (Goodbye)

[Music]

DO NOT COPY